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# Three Simple Prompts

Stop starting over. Three ways to get better answers from AI by asking more than once.

From Jason Greer's session. Free to use, copy and share at work. Anything in **[brackets]** is yours to fill in.

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**Before you start: AI is an eager intern. It wants to help. It still needs a boss.**

- Leave out customer names, personal information and company secrets.
- Check it before you trust it.
- Use the tool your company approves. These work in ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude or Gemini.

Ask IT one question: does our plan train on what we type? If nobody knows, don't upload anything yet. And keep a person signing off on every decision.

## 1 · THE ROOM · WHEN YOU NEED OTHER POINTS OF VIEW

Act as a panel of 4 people: **[the boss]**, **[the person who does the work]**, **[the customer]** and a skeptic. Each one gives their view on this problem: **[your problem]**. Then let them respond to each other for 3 rounds. End with what they agree on and what they still disagree on.

## 2 · THE 100 TRIES · WHEN YOU WANT TO KNOW WHAT MAKES IT BETTER OR WORSE

### NO DATA

Imagine 100 different ways to solve this problem: **[your problem]**. Sort them into best, average and worst. Then tell me what the best ones have in common and what the worst ones have in common.

### WITH DATA (ATTACH THE FILE)

Here is my data. Sort the **[runs]** from best to worst. What do the worst **[runs]** have in common? What do the best **[runs]** have in common?

## 3 · THE DAILY LOOP · WHEN YOU'LL BE DOING THIS AGAIN TOMORROW

Help me with **[your problem]** using Plan, Do, Check, Act.
**Plan:** What should I try?
**Do:** What exactly should I do today?
**Check:** How will I know if it worked?
**Act:** What should I change next time?
**At the end, write me a better version of this prompt to use tomorrow.**

## AI finds where. You still find why.

Can't upload a file? The Room and The Daily Loop work just by typing. Never used AI? Start with The Room. It needs no file and works on any phone.

PROMPT 1

# The Room

## Get more than one point of view.

When you ask AI one question, you get one voice. It sounds confident and a little bland. The good stuff in a meeting comes out when people disagree. The Room gets you that argument without booking a conference room.

### HOW TO USE IT

- **Pick people who would disagree.** Four managers give you one opinion four times. A good start: the boss (cares about cost and time), the person who does the work (knows what really happens), the customer (feels the result) and a skeptic (asks “how do you know?”). The AI plays all four.
- **Have data? Attach it.** No data is fine too.
- **Long reply? Scroll to the bottom first:** what they agree on and what they still disagree on.
- **The disagreement is where you go look.** One answer picks a side for you. The room shows you the trade-off.
- **Then go ask the real one.** The AI version of the person who does the work is a rehearsal for that conversation, not a replacement.

### USE IT FOR

A hard decision. A plan before you share it with your boss. An email that could land wrong (put the person getting it in the room and ask how it lands). A change people will push back on.

### DAILY USERS: LEVEL UP

Add “Be blunt, and push back on each other.” and “Keep each person to two sentences.”

PROMPT 2

# The 100 Tries

## See what makes it better or worse.

One game tells you a story. A hundred games show you the pattern. A good coach watches the film from all of them.

### HOW TO USE IT

- **Don’t read all 100.** Read the bottom: what the best ones have in common and what the worst ones have in common. That’s the part you can use on the next problem too.
- **One honest note:** with no data, the AI imagines the 100 tries. It doesn’t run them. Treat what comes back as ideas to check, not facts.
- **Have real data? Give it that instead.** With data, a try is something that already happened: a production run, a sales call, a late job, a changeover, a customer email.
- **Start small:** one export, a few weeks. Too big to paste? Attach the file. Opening a big file sometimes needs a paid plan, so use your company’s approved account.

- **Tell it how you count.** Give it your shift times and your definitions up front. Our practice file had no shift column, and two fresh chats counted the problem runs 97 and 103. A spreadsheet said 102. Same runs, three counts.

### THREE HABITS

- **Ask what the worst ones have in common, not who did worst.** "Who scrapped the most?" goes looking for a name. "What do the worst runs have in common?" goes looking for a cause. You can't be curious and judgmental at the same time.
- **Always ask about the best ones too.** If they have nothing in common, that's a finding. Don't copy luck.
- **Big call, like a person's name?** Check it in a brand new chat: "Someone else made this claim. Find out if it's wrong."

### USE IT FOR

Which jobs run late. Which changeovers go smooth. Which sales calls close. Which customer emails get a reply.

PROMPT 3

## The Daily Loop

*Make tomorrow's prompt better than today's.*

Tomorrow you open a new chat, and the AI has forgotten everything you figured out today. So put the learning in the prompt. **The AI won't remember what you learned today. Your prompt will.**

### HOW TO USE IT

- **The last line is the trick.** You don't have to be good at writing prompts. The AI folds what you learned today into tomorrow's prompt, and it gets a little better every day.
- **Watch Check.** Most teams skip it. A good Check sets a success number before the test. The AI can suggest one. Your team owns it.
- **Tomorrow:** open a new chat, paste in the prompt it wrote, attach the new data and fill in the blanks with what happened.

### SAVE IT LIKE STANDARD WORK

- Read it before you save it. It's your process now, not the AI's.
- Put a date on it and give it an owner.
- Keep it where your team can find it. A shared doc is fine.
- One prompt per problem. Trim it when it gets past one screen.

### WHAT DAY 2 LOOKED LIKE

When we ran The Daily Loop on the practice plant, this is the prompt it wrote for tomorrow, word for word. The brackets are its blanks to fill in.

> I run a **[stamping]** plant with 4 presses making **[parts / what they're for]**. "Scrap" means **[what counts as scrap for us]**. Normal scrap for us is about 2.2%.
>
> Attached is our production log, one row per run, from **[start date]** to **[end date]**. Columns: run_id, start/end time, machine, part, material_lot (supplier + lot number), operator, units_produced, units_scrapped, first_piece_result, downtime_min, comment. Shifts start at **[6 am, 2 pm and 10 pm]**. Op 14, 22 and 27 work evenings; Op 11, 12, 13 and 15 work days.
>
> What we already know: Plant scrap rose from about 2.2% to 3.2% over 12 weeks. Nearly all of the increase is Press 2, evening crew, Ridgeline coil (about 8% last week). The same press on days, and the same operators on other presses, stay around 2.2%. Parts pass first piece and then drift out of size during the run.
>
> What I tested yesterday: **[the change, e.g. "ran Press 2 evenings on day-shift settings"]**.
> Results: **[units produced and scrapped per run, size readings every 30 minutes, adjustments made, gauge check result, anything operators said]**.
>
> Constraints: **[e.g. can't stop production, no new equipment this month, maintenance available Tuesday]**.
>
> Please run the next PDCA loop:
> 1. Check: Did yesterday's test work, compared with the 7.7% baseline? How confident should I be given how many runs I have?
> 2. Plan: What are the top 3 likely causes now, ranked, with the evidence for and against each? What can't the data tell us?
> 3. Do: Pick ONE change to test next. Give me step-by-step instructions for one shift, including what to measure and how often.
> 4. Check: Set a success number before I start, and tell me how many runs I need before I trust the result.
> 5. Act: What should I make standard if it works, and what should I try next if it doesn't?
>
> Use plain language and show the key numbers in a small table. If anything in the data looks wrong or missing, tell me before you analyze it.

BEFORE YOU ACT ON ANY ANSWER

## AI is a tool, not a problem solver

AI doesn't change root cause analysis. You still keep asking why until you reach a cause you can test. You still go to the gemba. You still reason it through: does your story fit every fact, even the odd ones? And you still check the AI.

| Five steps of root cause analysis | AI or people? |
|---|---|
| 1 Spot it | Your people, your charts, or AI |
| 2 Narrow where | **AI is fast here** |
| 3 Go and see | **Only people** |
| 4 Ask why | **People lead, AI suggests** |
| 5 Test and confirm | **People decide** |

**AI gets you to the gemba faster. It doesn't make the trip for you.**

PRACTICE

# Try it on the practice plant

The file **production_runs.csv** is a made-up plant where scrap went up. It was built with a problem hidden in it on purpose, so nobody's real plant or real people are in it. It's the same file used in the session.

- 967 production runs over 12 weeks, April 6 to June 26, 2026
- 4 presses, 4 parts, 7 operators and 2 steel suppliers (Cormont and Ridgeline)
- One row per run: run_id, start_time, end_time, machine, part, material_lot, operator, units_produced, units_scrapped, first_piece_result, downtime_min, comment
- There's no shift column, on purpose. Day shift starts at 6 am and second shift at 2 pm. Tell the AI that.

### TRY THIS

1. Run **The Room** with the file attached. For the problem, use: scrap went up over the last 12 weeks and we need to know why.
2. Run **The 100 Tries** with the data version of the prompt.
3. Run **The Daily Loop**, then save the prompt it writes for tomorrow.
4. **Check its numbers yourself.** Add a column for scrap rate (units_scrapped ÷ units_produced), sort it, and filter.

Want to compare? "What the AI Said" has the full replies we got and, on its last page, what we found and how we checked it.

**Need a problem to practice on?**

Shift handoffs that keep missing things. New hires quitting in their first 90 days. Customers calling about late orders.

Questions later? Jason Greer · Jason@peelbusinessdesign.com